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Computer Engineering

Company: Barclays

Job Profile: Intern

Offer Type: Internship Only

Internship Stipend: 75k/month

CTC:

Location: Pune

Process Date: 12th September 2024

Placement Process:

1. **Online assessment** (280+ candidates)

The first round was an online assessment held in the college lab. Despite being an online test, it was monitored closely to ensure fairness. The test consisted of:

- **12 multiple-choice questions (MCQs)** on topics such as data structures, algorithms, and aptitude.
- **1 coding question**, which required solving a problem using programming logic.
- **1 SQL question**, where candidates had to write a query based on a given dataset.

The time duration for this round was **1 hour**. Out of 280+ candidates, **35** were shortlisted for the next round based on their performance.

Preparation Tips:

- For the MCQs, focus on core subjects like data structures, algorithms, and basic aptitude. Websites like **GeeksforGeeks**, **LeetCode**, and **HackerRank** are excellent for practicing these.
- The coding question required a solid understanding of programming. Practice coding problems from competitive platforms and make sure to brush up on common algorithms.
- Prepare SQL queries and database management concepts, as SQL questions often focus on real-world applications.

On the day of the test, ensure you manage time efficiently between the MCQs and the coding questions. Double-check your SQL query for syntax and logic errors.

Resume Pointers:

- Highlight projects involving coding, data structures, and databases.
- Include any relevant certifications in programming or SQL that demonstrate your skills.

2. Technical Interview (35 candidates)

After the online assessment, **35 candidates** were shortlisted for the technical interview, which was conducted offline the next day. This round involved in-depth questions about:

- Your technical knowledge of programming languages, data structures, and algorithms.
- Problem-solving skills, where you might be asked to solve problems on a whiteboard or explain your thought process.
- Questions about projects listed on your resume, with particular emphasis on your role, challenges faced, and how you overcame them.

The interview lasted for around **30-40 minutes** per candidate, and **15** people were shortlisted for the next round.

Preparation Tips:

- Review your resume thoroughly, especially the projects and technologies you mentioned.
- Practice explaining complex technical concepts in simple terms. Mock interviews can help with this.
- Prepare for questions on problem-solving using DSA (Data Structures and Algorithms) by solving problems from LeetCode and InterviewBit.

On the day of the interview, stay calm, maintain clarity in your answers, and don't hesitate to ask for clarification if needed. Always explain your thought process when solving problems.

3. HR Interview (15 candidates)

The final round was an HR interview, conducted offline in the evening of the same day. In this round, the HR panel focused on:

- Behavioral questions to assess your personality, teamwork skills, and how you handle pressure.
- Questions about your career goals, strengths, weaknesses, and why you're interested in the company.
- Situational questions, where you may be asked how you would handle a particular scenario in the workplace.

This round was relatively short, around 15-20 minutes per candidate. After this round, 13 candidates were finally selected for the role.

Preparation Tips:

- Practice answering common HR questions like "Tell me about yourself", "Where do you see yourself in 5 years?", and "Why should we hire you?".
- Be honest about your strengths and weaknesses, and give examples that show how you've worked on improving your weaknesses.
- Ensure you are well-versed with the company's background, culture, and the role you're applying for.

On the day of the HR interview, be confident, maintain good body language, and ensure your answers reflect a positive attitude and willingness to learn.

Useful Tips:

- Consistent preparation is key. Make sure you practice a variety of problems, especially focusing on coding and SQL.
- During technical interviews, always communicate your approach clearly, even if you're unsure of the solution. Interviewers appreciate seeing your thought process.
- For the HR round, focus on presenting yourself as a well-rounded candidate with both technical and soft skills.
- Time management during the online assessment is crucial—practice timed tests beforehand to get used to the pressure.

Resources that helped me prepare:

- **GeeksforGeeks** for brushing up on data structures and algorithms.
- **LeetCode** and **HackerRank** for coding practice.
- **SQLZoo** and **W3Schools** for SQL practice.

Stay confident, be well-prepared, and don't hesitate to clarify doubts during the interview.